

Seniors United Now

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

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To:
Dan Stadlwieser
Chair – PSPP Sponsor Board

Subject: COLA and the pension coordinated option
January 30, 2023 Letter from SUN
July 18, 2023 PSPP Response letter

We do appreciate your time commitment, reviewing our previous correspondence relating to this very important issue.

However, we must bring to your attention our disappointment in the conclusions identified in your July 18, 2023 letter. In the Summer 2023 Issue of LAPP NEWS, under this section “The pensions Canadians want”, states “that employees want retirement income that adjusts for inflation”. The PSPP plan allows for only 60% of COLA which ensures that pensioners are unable to keep pace with inflation. With a surplus of 12.7 billion dollars in the pension fund it is difficult to understand why even a small or a one-time adjustment was not considered.

Having pension members who did not fully understand the consequences to enrolling in the coordination option, some of them are now over the age of 80 or 90 years old, have repaid in excess of \$150,000 more than they ever received, and under your current system are still paying until the day they die, this is a significant ethical problem that needs to be corrected.

In your letter you also indicated that altering the coordination option at age 75 would result in unfair treatment among members. On the front page of LAPP NEWS, it states a “New pension option is coming which is called the joint lifetime reduced by 1/3 on members death only and guaranteed 5 years”. In this instance there seems to be no concern of unfair treatment for past members who did not have this option. Pension options do not appear to be applied equally.

On behalf of our members, I assume you can recognize the frustration of our members, and it is important to bring these two issues to your attention.

Thanking you in advance for your response, the opportunity to correspond with you, and ideally, to meet with you in person for further dialog.

Sincerely,

Wayne Sorenson

Wayne Sorenson, President

C.C. Troy Mann - President & Chief Executive Officer - LAPP

